

Hydrocarbon Fumes/“Huffing”

Key Concepts

- Immediate extrication of patient to fresh air
- Initial Dry Decontamination with blotting visible hydrocarbon / paint with multiple clean cloths
- Secondary Decon with soap and warm water
- High flow oxygen
- Treat Cardiac Arrhythmias
- Never use Epinephrine or Albuterol

Hydrocarbon Fumes Toxicity

- Paint or Paint thinner can be “Huffed” by placing in a plastic bag and inhaling the fumes.
- Lethal Inhalational exposure can occur from Hydrocarbon fumes from Oil or Chemical tanks
- Hydrocarbons irritate cardiac tissues and can cause PVCs, Torsade's or VFIB
- **DO NOT use Epinephrine/Albuterol**
- Beta Blockers prevent and treat the tachyarrhythmias

EMT/AEMT

- Follow Trauma General Patient Care Guideline
- Remove all clothing and decontaminate-Blot /wipe with clean cloths to remove oil-based residues
- Secondary DECON **immediately with soap and any available water source**
- Protect from hypothermia, warm water preferred
- Follow Adult Resuscitation Guideline, as indicated

Paramedic

- Consider early intubation for altered mental status or respiratory distress
- Apply Monitor and evaluate for arrhythmias
- Start IV/IO and administer fluid bolus if HR>120 or BP<90
- Administer Beta blocker for arrhythmias (Tachycardia, PVC/s Torsade's)
 - **Metoprolol** 5mg slow IV Push and may repeat every 5 minutes times three
- If Cardiac Arrest Occurs DO NOT use Epinephrine
- DO Not use Albuterol for wheezing
- Call On Line Medical Direction for further recommendations and treatments